LANDMARK HISTORICAL EVENTS – MUMBAI & FREEDOM STRUGGLE

Grade 8 ICSE Social Studies (Mumbai) | Quick Revision Notes + Comparative Table + Practice Q&A

1. QUICK REVISION NOTES — TURNING POINTS IN THE NATIONAL MOVEMENT

1. Foundation of the Indian National Congress (28–31 December 1885)

- Founded at **Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College in Bombay (Mumbai)** with **72 delegates** from across India (History of the INC); initiated by retired ICS officer **Allan Octavian Hume** (General Secretary) with **Womesh Chunder Bonnerjee** elected as first President.
- Prominent Bombay delegates included Dadabhai Naoroji, Pherozeshah Mehta, and Badruddin Tyabji, creating an all-India platform for civil and constitutional dialogue.

2. Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–1922)

- Launched on **4 September 1920** by Mahatma Gandhi (Britannica) following outrage over the Rowlatt Act, the Jallianwala Bagh massacre (1919), and the Khilafat issue.
- Directed from Gandhi's Mumbai headquarters at Mani Bhavan; Indians boycotted British titles, legislatures, law courts, and foreign cloth while promoting hand-spun **khadi**, national schools, and Hindu-Muslim unity.

3. Salt March (Dandi Satyagraha) & Civil Disobedience (12 March – 6 April 1930)

- A 24-day, 387-km (240-mile) nonviolent march led by Mahatma Gandhi and **78 volunteers** from Sabarmati Ashram to **Dandi** to defy the oppressive British salt monopoly and tax (Britannica).
- Breaking the salt law at 8:30 am on **6 April 1930** ignited mass Civil Disobedience across the Bombay Presidency, including coastal salt satyagrahas, hartals, and boycotts of British goods in Mumbai.

4. Quit India Movement – August Kranti (8 August 1942)

- Launched at the Bombay session of the All India Congress Committee at Gowalia Tank Maidan (now **August Kranti Maidan**, Mumbai) on **8 August 1942** after the failure of the Cripps Mission during World War II.
- In his historic Quit India speech, Mahatma Gandhi gave the mantra **"Do or Die"** demanding immediate British withdrawal; described by Viceroy Linlithgow as *"by far the most serious rebellion since 1857."*

2. COMPARATIVE TABLE – EASY TO REMEMBER

Feature	First INC Session	Non-Cooperation	Salt March (CDM)	Quit India Movement
Date / Year	28–31 December 1885	4 September 1920 – 1922	12 March – 6 April 1930	8 August 1942
Key Location	Gokuldas Tejpal College, Mumbai	Nationwide (Mani Bhavan, Mumbai HQ)	Sabarmati to Dandi (387 km) & Bombay	Gowalia Tank Maidan, Mumbai
Key Leaders	A. O. Hume, W. C. Bonnerjee, Naoroji	Mahatma Gandhi & Congress volunteers	Mahatma Gandhi & 78 volunteers	Mahatma Gandhi, Azad, Patel
Core Method / Slogan	Constitutional petitions (72 delegates)	Swadeshi khadi & boycott of British rule	Defying British salt tax & civil disobedience	*"Do or Die"* — Immediate independence

3. PRACTICE QUESTIONS & ANSWER KEY (ICSE EXAM PREP)

Q1. Where was the first session of the Indian National Congress held in December 1885, and how many delegates attended? — **Ans:** At **Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College, Bombay (Mumbai)**, attended by **72 delegates** under President W. C. Bonnerjee.

Q2. How long was the 1930 Salt March, and why was it launched? — **Ans:** It spanned **24 days (387 km)** from Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi with 78 volunteers to break the British salt monopoly.

Q3. Name the Mumbai ground where the Quit India Movement was launched on 8 August 1942. — **Ans:** Gowalia Tank Maidan (August Kranti Maidan), where Gandhi gave the slogan **"Do or Die."**

MEMORY TIP: Remember the Chronological Freedom Chain — **1885 → 1920 → 1930 → 1942**: *"**C**ongress born in Bombay (1885) → **N**on-Cooperation (1920) → **S**alt Satyagraha (1930) → **Q**uit India at Gowalia Tank (1942)!"*